Acmad M. Tomawis

Acmad Maruhom Tomawis is a Maranao politician, government administrator, and businessman from Lanao del Sur, Philippines. He currently serves as Administrator and Chief Executive Officer of the Southern Philippines Development Authority (SPDA), and previously represented the ALIF (Ang Laban ng Indiginong Filipino) party-list in the House of Representatives for three consecutive terms. He also served as Executive Director of the Office on Muslim Affairs (OMA) and, earlier in his career, owned and operated a private bus transport company serving Northern and Central Mindanao.

Contents

1 Overview
2 Early Life & Family
3 Career, Public Service & Leadership Roles
  3.1 ARMM Regional Legislative Assembly
  3.2 Domestic Transport Business (1990s)
  3.3 Executive Director, Office on Muslim Affairs (OMA)
  3.4 Founder, ALIF Party-list
  3.5 Member, House of Representatives (ALIF Party-list)
  3.6 Administrator and CEO, Southern Philippines Development Authority
4 Major Works, Achievements, Awards & Recognition
5 Personal Life, Legacy, Impact & Historical Significance
6 Research Assessment

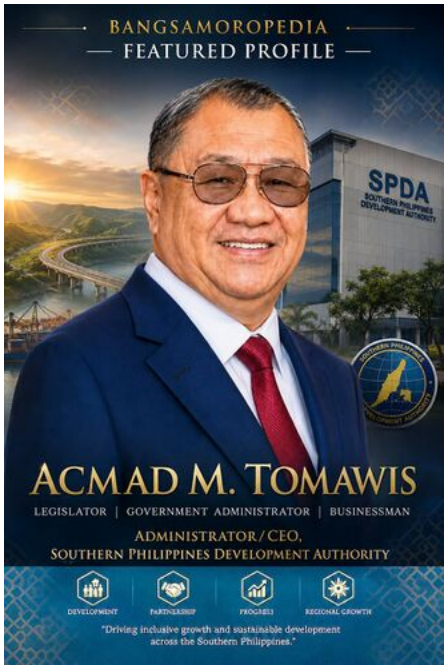
Overview

Tomawis has moved between elected office, appointive government posts, and private enterprise across nearly five decades of public life in Lanao del Sur and the wider Bangsamoro region. He founded the ALIF party-list group in Marawi City in February 2003 and represented it in Congress from 2004 to 2013.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref><ref>Mindanews, "Mindanawons in Congress: 67 in the House, two in the Senate," 2013.</ref> He was appointed Administrator and CEO of SPDA around June 2026, succeeding Abdulghani "Gerry" Ajul Salapuddin.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

Early Life & Family

Verified information on Tomawis's exact date of birth, early schooling, and formal education has not been located in government records, news archives, or academic sources as of this writing.

Acmad M. Tomawis



Administrator and CEO, Southern Philippines Development Authority

In office	c. June 2026 – present
Preceded by	Abdulghani "Gerry" Ajul Salapuddin

Member of the House of Representatives (ALIF Party-list)

In office	c. 2004 – 2013 (13th–15th Congress)

Executive Director, Office on Muslim Affairs

In office	June 1998 – January 2001

Personal details

Born	Marawi City, Lanao del Sur (date unconfirmed)
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao
Political party	ALIF (Ang Laban ng Indiginong Filipino), founder
Relatives	Sultan Yahya "Jerry" Tomawis (brother, former SPDA Administrator); Abdul Tomawis, Agakhan Tomawis (sons, ALIF nominees)

Occupation	Government administrator, politician, businessman

Secondary sources describe him as originating from Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, and beginning public life there, though the earliest specific dates in circulation (a councilorship starting in 1976, a mayoralty from 1978, and an ARMM assembly seat "from 1982 to 1996") do not align with the historical record, since the ARMM itself was not established until 1989 and its first Regional Legislative Assembly only convened in 1990.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref> These earlier claims are flagged here as unverified pending a primary source.

His brother is Sultan Yahya "Jerry" Tomawis, who administered SPDA during the 2000s, the same agency Acmad now leads.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref> His sons Abdul Tomawis and Agakhan Tomawis have both served as ALIF party-list nominees.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref> A 2010 party-list nominee list also names Jamela M. Tomawis as ALIF's fourth nominee, though her exact relationship to Acmad has not been independently confirmed. <ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

Research gap: Date of birth, place of birth details beyond city, parents' names, and formal educational history are not yet documented in citable sources.

Career, Public Service & Leadership Roles

ARMM Regional Legislative Assembly

Tomawis sat in the 1st ARMM Regional Legislative Assembly (1990–1993), representing Lanao del Sur's first district, and returned briefly to the 2nd Assembly from May 28 to September 30, 1996, under the Laban ng Demokratikong Pilipino (LDP) banner.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref><ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

Domestic Transport Business (1990s)

Before entering Congress, Tomawis owned and operated **Tomawis Super Transport** (known in its early operations as **AMT Express**), a bus and transport line serving Northern and Central Mindanao. City-route operations began in 1993 using former Metro Manila Transit Corporation (MMTC) units, expanding to regional routes by 1994. Primary routes included Cagayan de Oro–Marawi (via Iligan), Cagayan de Oro–Butuan, and Cagayan de Oro–Wao (via Valencia and Maramag), operated using Nissan Diesel units and surplus Japanese coaches.<ref>Community transport-history archive, Iligan City 1990s bus operations, Facebook.</ref> This business is the basis for his continuing local reputation as a transport-sector businessman.

Executive Director, Office on Muslim Affairs (OMA)

Tomawis served as Executive Director of the Office on Muslim Affairs (OMA) from June 1998 to January 2001, appointed under the administration of President Joseph Estrada.<ref>Firsthand account, former OMA Planning Director under Tomawis's term.</ref> A Philippine Supreme Court decision independently places him in the post by mid-1998: in G.R. No. 166547, the Court's narration of facts states that on July 3, 1998, then-OMA Executive Director Acmad Tomawis removed a regional director from post and appointed a replacement.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

As Executive Director, Tomawis headed an agency created under Executive Order No. 122-A (1987), which established OMA with a mandate to ensure the rights and well-being of Muslim Filipinos, organized around bureaus covering pilgrimage and endowment, cultural affairs, cooperatives development, and settlements. <ref>Template:Cite web</ref> His tenure centered on three areas:

Bureau of Pilgrimage and Endowment. Tomawis oversaw the agency's annual Hajj operations, a function EO 122-A assigns to the Bureau of Pilgrimage and Endowment, covering the administration of the annual Muslim pilgrimage to Mecca, Saudi Arabia, and the management of Awqaf (endowment) properties and institutions.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref> By firsthand account, this included coordinating logistics, medical assistance, and travel processing for Muslim Filipino pilgrims, and administering properties and endowments designated for the welfare of the Muslim community.<ref>Firsthand account, former OMA Planning Director under Tomawis's term.</ref>

The 2000 Mindanao conflict. Tomawis's term coincided with President Estrada's "all-out war" campaign against the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF), declared on March 21, 2000, a military campaign that independent sources describe as displacing hundreds of thousands of civilians before the MILF's main camp fell in July 2000.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref><ref>Template:Cite web</ref> By firsthand account, Tomawis pivoted OMA's operations toward socio-economic relief for internally displaced Moro civilians during the conflict, and advised the Office of the President on the cultural and political implications of the fighting, advocating non-military interventions and multi-faith dialogue.<ref>Firsthand account, former OMA Planning Director under Tomawis's term.</ref>

Shariah and institutional development. By firsthand account, Tomawis backed the institutionalization of Madaris (Islamic schools) and provided legal and logistical support to the country's Shariah court system during his term.<ref>Firsthand account, former OMA Planning Director under Tomawis's term.</ref> The agency he led was later abolished under Republic Act No. 9997 (February 18, 2010), which created the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF) and transferred OMA's functions to it.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

Founder, ALIF Party-list

Organized ALIF (Ang Laban ng Indiginong Filipino) in Marawi City in February 2003 following consultations with indigenous cultural community leaders, including Muslim Filipinos.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

Member, House of Representatives (ALIF Party-list)

Won a House seat in the 2004 elections; ALIF topped the party-list vote in several ARMM provinces, though discrepancies in the Lanao del Sur count led rival group Cibac to formally question the results.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref> He served three consecutive terms, through the 15th Congress (2010–2013).<ref>Mindanews, "Mindanawons in Congress: 67 in the House, two in the Senate," 2013.</ref> In 2007, he joined other party-list representatives in signing a "Covenant of Common Purpose and United Action" bringing several party-list groups into the Lakas-CMD coalition under then-Speaker Jose de Venecia.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

A 2004 accreditation petition by Kilosbayan argued that Tomawis's business background, described as overseas trucking, particularly in Iraq, undercut ALIF's claim to represent a marginalized sector.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref><ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

As a sitting representative, Senate records list him as principal author of several bills, including a tuition fee discount measure for students from indigenous cultural communities, a bill establishing the Sultan Labay Technical Institute in Masiu, Lanao del Sur, and a bill exempting overseas Filipino workers from taxes and customs duties on vehicles brought into the country.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

Administrator and CEO, Southern Philippines Development Authority

Appointed Administrator and CEO of SPDA around June 2026. Shortly after assuming office, he ordered a 30-day fast-track reopening of the Sulop Poultry Farm in Davao del Sur, personally conducting a site visitation with SPDA's management team on June 20, 2026.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref> SPDA also credited his leadership with a June 17, 2026 donation of relief goods to earthquake-affected Sarangani province.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref>

Research gap: SPDA's published "Personal Profile" page had not been updated to reflect Tomawis's appointment as of this writing, so the exact appointment date and appointing order are not yet available from a primary source.

Major Works, Achievements, Awards & Recognition

- Founded and operated Tomawis Super Transport (AMT Express), a bus line serving Northern and Central Mindanao routes through the 1990s.
- Founded ALIF, sustaining it as a functioning party-list group that won House seats across three consecutive congressional elections.
- Principal author of legislation covering indigenous student tuition discounts, technical education in Lanao del Sur, and tax relief for returning overseas Filipino workers.
- As SPDA Administrator, initiated an early operational push to revive the Sulop Poultry Farm as an income-generating project, alongside directives to resolve environmental compliance issues with the local government unit.

No independently verified awards, honors, or formal citations have been located as of this writing.

Personal Life, Legacy, Impact & Historical Significance

Tomawis's career reflects a political and business family with sustained influence across Lanao del Sur and the wider ARMM/BARMM region. His brother Jerry Tomawis administered SPDA during the Arroyo era, working on infrastructure and livelihood projects such as the Koronadal Business Center.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref> Decades later, Acmad now holds the same administratorship. His sons' continued involvement in ALIF, together with the family's footprint across SPDA, the ARMM legislative assembly, and Congress, places the Tomawis family among a small set of Maranao political families whose influence spans multiple government institutions over several decades.

A 2012 report on a pyramiding-scam bust noted that the scheme's operator was married to a daughter of then-SPDA chairman Jerry Tomawis, identified in that article as Acmad's brother.<ref>Template:Cite web</ref> Acmad is not named as a party to that case in available sources; this is included here strictly as family-background context.

Research Assessment

Verified facts: ALIF founding (February 2003); OMA Executive Director tenure, June 1998 to January 2001, per firsthand account from a former OMA Planning Director who served under him, with the mid-1998 portion independently corroborated by a Supreme Court decision; three consecutive House terms (2004–2013); 1st ARMM Regional Legislative Assembly seat (1990–1993) and brief 2nd Assembly service (1996); current SPDA Administrator/CEO role (2026); declared net worth of ₱18.56 million per 2012 SALN; ownership of Tomawis Super Transport/AMT Express, corroborated by an independent period photograph of a "Tomawis"-branded bus on the Cagayan de Oro–Iligan route and by firsthand recollection from a former OMA colleague. The structural mandate and historical context of his OMA tenure (EO 122-A's bureau functions, the 2000 Estrada-MILF conflict, and OMA's 2010 abolition under RA 9997) are each independently documented in law and historical record; the

specific claim that Tomawis personally carried out relief coordination, peace advocacy, and Shariah/Madaris institutional support during that period rests on firsthand testimony rather than independent documentary sources, and is presented here on that basis.

Unverified information: Claimed 1976 councilorship and 1978 mayoralty; claimed ARMM assembly tenure "1982–1996" (inconsistent with ARMM's actual founding date); undated OIC Mayor of Marawi role; exact family relationship of ALIF nominee Jamela M. Tomawis.

Research gaps: Date and place of birth; parents' names and pre-political family background; formal educational history; exact SPDA appointment date and order; a government, SEC, or news-archive citation for Tomawis Super Transport/AMT Express; awards and honors.

Editorial Notice: BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

Retrieved from "https://wiki.maranaw.com/index.php?title=Acmad_M._Tomawis&oldid=3144"